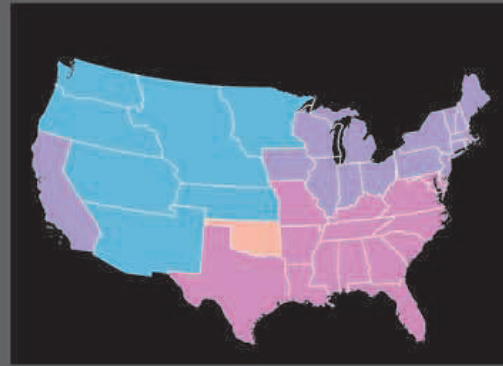




1854: THE KANSAS-NEBRASKA ACT

One of the compromise acts in 1850 was to allow the Utah and New Mexico territories to reach a decision on slavery when they became states. The Kansas-Nebraska Act applied this principle for people in those states, allowing them to vote on the issue. This act also controversially repealed the Missouri Compromise, causing further anger in the North.



1857: THE DRED SCOTT DECISION

The growing abolitionist cause received a setback when the Supreme Court ruled in the case of Dred Scott v. John F. A. Sandford (see 1857) that slavery was legal in all the territories. The judges also declared that the Missouri Compromise was unconstitutional. They argued that it was up to states to decide to ban slavery, but that territories were not states.

KEY

- Free states
- Free territories
- Slave states
- Territories where slavery legal
- Territories newly opened to slavery 1854
- Area not subject to standard territorial laws

KEY

- Free states
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AMERICAN CIVIL WAR

THE CONFLICT THAT TORE THE UNITED STATES APART

The shells fired at Fort Sumter, South Carolina, in 1861 not only ripped the country in two, but also began a deadly conflict that would pit families against each other, with brother fighting brother on the battlefield, as the Confederacy of Southern states took up arms in defense of slavery.

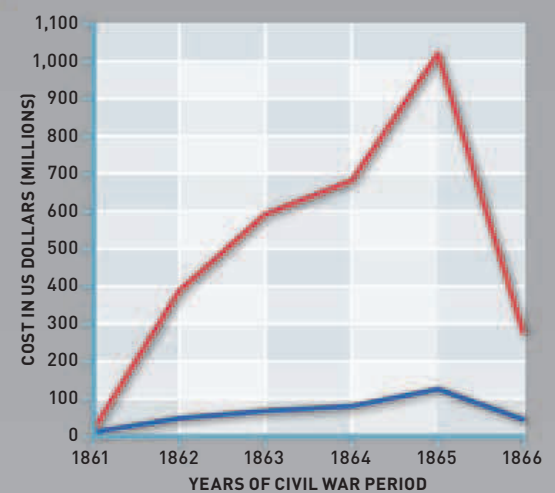
The issue was not only ideological, but also economic. Southerners felt that their rural, agrarian livelihood was under direct threat from the policies of the federal government. And for the industrial and urban North and President Abraham Lincoln, the question was about more than freedom for slaves. Without the 15 slave states, what would the future hold for the Union? The war cost billions and destroyed the Southern economy. The Union navy blockaded ports causing prices in the South to skyrocket; the price of a cup of coffee in

a restaurant in Richmond, Virginia, reached around \$5 by 1864. By the time the South conceded defeat and surrendered in 1865, both sides had been heavily battered—but the country emerged united.

The war was also significant because it was the harbinger of modern warfare. Infrastructure developments, such as railroads, and technological innovations in armaments like breech-loading rifles had changed the nature of battle, and led to a much higher number of casualties.

OVER THE COURSE OF THE CIVIL WAR, THE UNION PROVIDED SOLDIERS WITH

1 BILLION ROUNDS OF AMMUNITION
100 MILLION POUNDS OF COFFEE
10 MILLION PAIRS OF PANTS
1 MILLION HORSES AND MULES



KEY
 ● Union army expenditure
 ● Union navy expenditure

Cost of the war

Billions were spent fighting the Civil War, with the army and navy costing the Union millions during this period. The estimated cost to the Confederacy, including the emancipation of the slaves, was around \$2.1 billion, inflicting serious damage to the Southern economy.

Populations

The industrial North had a much larger population than the mostly agrarian Southern states.

23
MILLION
UNION POPULATION

9
MILLION
CONFEDERATE
POPULATION

\$1,200

THE COST OF A BARREL OF FLOUR IN VIRGINIA BY 1865



1:3 Outnumbered
 Despite the South being significantly outnumbered, the fighting continued for four years, leaving some 600,000 dead.